

54 Articles

Articles are some of the shortest and most common words in the English language. There are several rules stating which article, if any, should be used.

 **New language** Articles

Aa Vocabulary Commonly misspelled words

 **New skill** Saying words with silent letters

54.1 KEY LANGUAGE THE DEFINITE ARTICLE

Use the definite article "the" when the person or thing you are referring to is easily identifiable.

We went on a tour and **the guide** was excellent.

It is clear from the context that this means the tour guide.



This includes situations where a person or thing has already been mentioned.

There's a bus trip or a lecture. I'd prefer **the bus trip**.

The bus trip has already been mentioned.



Use the definite article before superlatives.

The Colosseum is probably **the most famous** site in Rome.

The definite article is used before superlatives such as "most famous."



The definite article is also used with unique objects.

I'm going to **the Trevi Fountain** before I check out.

The Trevi Fountain is a unique object.



It is also used for people with unique titles.

The Pope is visiting another country this week.

"Pope" is a title.



54.2 KEY LANGUAGE THE INDEFINITE ARTICLE

Use the indefinite articles "a" and "an" when the exact person or thing you are referring to is unknown.

We are trying to choose **a vacation**.

The vacation is a new thing that is being introduced.



Also use the indefinite article to talk about an entire class of people or things generally.

India is **a fascinating country** to visit.

